



**MENTAL HEALTH SERVICE OUTPATIENT AND CONSULTATION LIAISON
PROCEDURE**

**Discharge from WNHS Mental Health
Service Outpatient and Consultation
Liaison (OPCL)**

Scope (Staff):	Mental health staff working in WNHS
Scope (Area):	WNHS Mental Health Service Outpatient and Consultation Liaison

1. Aim

The purpose of this process is to ensure that patients are discharged from the Mental Health Service Outpatient and Consultation Liaison (OPCL) in a planned and systematic manner consistent with the North Metropolitan Health Service ([NMHS Discharge Summary Policy](#)), the [WNHS Discharge of Patient Policy](#), [Chief Psychiatrist's Guidelines 2015](#), [Mental Health Act 2014](#) and [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles](#)

2. Key Points

- The discharge plan is developed in collaboration with the patient. When appropriate the patient's partner and/or family are involved, with the patient's consent.
- Development of the discharge plan ideally occurs after completion of assessment and may need review during treatment for patients receiving ongoing care from OPCL.
- Progress towards treatment goals and follow up recommendations are reviewed with the patient prior to discharge.
- A range of discharge plans may be considered with the patient, recognising that some patients will need ongoing monitoring and care, within the mandate for services by OPCL. While others will require only assessment and referral or a brief episode of care. Options for discharge may include:
 - treatment completed
 - no further contact or follow-up required
 - patient opted to access other services
 - referral to the patient's General Practitioner (primary healthcare provider) for ongoing care
 - information provided for access to external health care provider
 - liaise with, refer to and facilitate access to other community health care provider
 - patient/carer to have responsibility for initiating future contact if required and within the mandate for services OPCL
 - patient declined or discontinued service access.

3. Process/ Documentation

- The clinician who completes the Assessment, or who sees the patient for assistance or treatment is responsible for forwarding relevant information about assessment, treatment, care and discharge plan to the referrer, the patient's General Practitioner; and/or the Child Health Nurse as appropriate; or to other community agencies, as clinically indicated via healthcare record letter, treatment, support and discharge plan ([SMHMR907](#)) or care transfer summary ([SMHMR916](#)) (for other Health Department agencies).
- Outpatients attending the department are informed via a Client Information sheet at the initial appointment, that the Service will share information relevant to their clinical care with other health professionals involved in their care. Clients are invited to discuss any concerns regarding this with the clinician they are seeing. Verbal consent for information sharing as above is sought from all patients where possible and noted in the patient's healthcare record.
- When an inpatient is reviewed on the ward, the clinician should note in the patient's medical record when the patient is cleared for discharge from an OPCL point of view and outline the discharge / follow-up plan.

Related policies

[Carers Recognition Act 2004](#)
[Charter of Mental Health Care Principles](#)
[Chief Psychiatrist's Guidelines 2015](#)
[Mental Health Act 2014](#)
[\(NMHS\) Discharge Summary Policy](#)

Related WNHS procedures and guidelines

[Women's and Perinatal Mental Health Referral and Management Guideline](#)
[WNHS Discharge of Patient Policy](#)

Keywords	Discharge, psychological medicine, mental health, procedure				
Policy Sponsor	Head of Department – WNHS Mental Health Service Outpatient and Consultation Liaison				
Policy Author	Consultant Clinical Psychology Director – WNHS Mental Health Service Outpatient and Consultation Liaison				
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Endorsed by:	Mental Health Clinical Practice and Outcomes Committee			Date:	04/08/2025
NSQHS Standards Applicable:	 Std 5: Comprehensive Care,  Std 6: Communicating for Safety				
Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care	Transfer of Care				
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Discharge from WNHS Mental Health Service Outpatient Consultation Liaison (OPCL)

Version History

Version number	Date	Summary
1.0	February 2003	First version. Title: Department of Psychological Medicine Delivery of Care Guidelines KEMH DC 19: Discharge from Psychological Medicine
2.0	July 2012	Regular review and update. Other dates unknown
3.0	July 2016	Format change. Title Clinical Practice guideline: Discharge from Psychological Medicine
4.0	August 2017	Regular review and update. Other dates unknown
5.0	July 2021	Format and title change: WNHS Procedure: Discharge from Psychological Medicine
6.0	June 2025	Three yearly review. Amendments include: • hyperlinks updated, with stable links where available • change of title to reflect departmental rename from Department of Psychological Medicine to WNHS Mental Health Service Outpatient Consultation Liaison (OPCL) • Associated departmental name change throughout the document • minor formatting and grammatical changes • removal of National Standards for Mental health Services and replaced with Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care to align with NMHS MH guideline format • Medical chart notes changed to healthcare record. Endorsed by Mental Health CPOC 4 August 2025

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